Table 9-3. *DateTimeInterface / date global constants*

Constant	Example
DateTime::COOKIE DATE_COOKIE	Sunday, 01-Sep-2024 08:00:00 UTC
DateTime::ISO8601 DATE_ISO8601	2024-09-01T08:00:00+0000
DateTime::RFC7231 DATE_RFC7231	Sun, 01 Sep 2024 08:00:00 GMT

All of the date module constants are also exposed as class constants of DateTime: DATE_COOKIE is DateTime::COOKIE, and so on. The full details for formatting dates are available at https://www.php.net/manual/en/datetime.format.php and https://www.php.net/manual/en/datetime.constants.php

DateTime and DateTimeZone

Unix timestamps are always in UTC time, but their expression as date and time strings depends on where in the world you happen to be, in other words, which time zone you are in. A DateTime object is at heart simply a UTC timestamp; its expression as a particular time and date depends on the timezone, and these are represented in PHP as DateTimeZone objects. When constructing DateTime objects with strings, you can include time zone information in various ways as part of the string:

```
$dt = new DateTime('Tuesday, 03-Sep-2024 05:00:00 PDT');
print $dt->format('Y-m-d H:i:s T') . PHP_EOL;
print $dt->format('Y-m-d H:i:s O') . PHP_EOL;
```

```
Output:
2024-09-03 05:00:00 PDT
2024-09-03 05:00:00 -0700
```

By adding the Pacific Daylight Time abbreviation of PDT to the formatted string, the time zone of the resulting DateTime object is now set (without it the time zone would be set to whatever the system settings are where PHP is running). DateTime instances will report their time zone settings as DateTimeZone class via the DateTime::getTimezone() method…

```
var_dump($dt->getTimezone());
```